DRAFT - FOR SPONSOR AND SRC REVIEW - NOT FOR USE WITH PARTICIPANTS

# INFORMED CONSENT / ASSENT

**FocusGuard: An Analysis of Real-Time Visual Distraction Detection Through Webcam-Based Gaze and Facial Landmark Tracking Using Heuristic and Decision Trees**

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Adult sponsor: Punam Singh (PunamKSingh@Katyisd.org)
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## What this study involves

- Purpose: to test whether FocusGuard can use a regular computer webcam to detect signs of distraction, such as looking away from the screen or looking at a phone, and whether alerts help you focus.
- The task: digits from 1 to 9 appear on screen one at a time, quite quickly. You press the space bar for every digit EXCEPT the digit 3, where you do nothing. It is repetitive on purpose - the point is to see what happens to attention over time, not to test how clever you are.
- Every minute or so the task pauses for a few seconds and asks where your attention was just before the pause, with four options to choose from. There is no right answer, nobody is judged on it, and honest answers are far more useful to the research than flattering ones.
- You will do three short blocks: two that are compared with each other, and one that only collects camera data without any alerts. Time required: about 55-65 minutes in total, including setup, the blocks, and breaks between them.
- In some blocks FocusGuard watches you through the webcam and may show a banner or play a short sound when it thinks you have been distracted. In one block the camera records without ever interrupting you, and in one it is not used at all.
- Possible risks: eye strain from using a computer, boredom or frustration from a deliberately repetitive task, frustration from alerts or automatic pauses, and privacy concerns from using a webcam. You can take breaks or stop at any time.
- Benefits: there may be no direct benefit to you. The results could help show whether FocusGuard can detect visual distractions and help people reduce phone use while working.
- Confidentiality: you are given a code instead of your name. Your webcam video never leaves this device - no image, video, or screenshot is uploaded or stored. The page turns each frame into a few numbers, such as how far your head is turned, and then discards the frame. Only those numbers, your task results, your answers to the attention questions, and your code are sent to the researcher.

- Participation is completely voluntary. If you decide not to take part there will be no negative consequences, and you may stop at any time or skip any question.

## What you are agreeing to

Please read each statement. Tick it only if it is true for you.

- ☐ I have read and understand the information above.
- ☐ I understand the task is repetitive by design, and that I will be interrupted about once a minute to answer a short question about my attention.
- ☐ I understand my webcam video stays on this device and is never uploaded.
- ☐ I understand participation is voluntary and I can stop at any time without giving a reason.
- ☐ I freely give my consent or assent to participate, or permission for my child to participate.

## If you have questions

Contact the adult sponsor, Punam Singh, at PunamKSingh@Katyisd.org. You may withdraw at any point, before or during the study, without giving a reason and without any consequence.

## Signatures

### Research participant

_____

Printed name

_____

Signature

_____

Date

## Parent or guardian (required if the participant is under 18)

_____

Printed name

_____

Signature

_____

Date

## Student researcher

_____

Printed name

_____

Signature

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Date

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